

Tailscale Windows: NoState After Windows Update

SEVERITY: LOW

STATUS: RESOLVED

TYPE: SERVICE STARTUP

Date	September 30, 2026
Environment	Windows 11 + Tailscale (Windows Client)
Impact	Tailnet connectivity unavailable after first boot post-update until service started

ISSUE

Issue

After installing a Windows update and signing back into Windows, Tailscale did not immediately initialize. The Tailscale CLI reported a **NoState** condition.

```
tailscale status

# Health check:
#   - Tailscale is starting. Please wait.

unexpected state: NoState

tailscale up # did not resolve – status continued to report NoState
```

ROOT CAUSE

Root Cause

The Tailscale Windows service was not running after the post-update boot, despite being configured for **Automatic** startup. This appears to be a transient Windows service startup ordering issue following the update, rather than a persistent misconfiguration.

RESOLUTION

Resolution

Action Taken

Manually started the Tailscale Windows service via Windows Services (services.msc). Once started, Tailscale initialized normally and Tailnet connectivity was restored.

No changes to startup configuration were required — service was already set to Automatic.

VERIFICATION

Verification

The system was rebooted again after manually starting the service. After the second reboot, Tailscale initialized automatically without any additional intervention, confirming the issue was a one-time startup failure.

CONCLUSION

Conclusion

This was a temporary Tailscale / Windows startup issue following the Windows update. No reinstallation or configuration changes were necessary. The service remains configured for Automatic startup.

RUNBOOK

If This Happens Again

01 Check Windows Services

Open services.msc and locate the Tailscale service.

02 Confirm Service State

If stopped, start the service manually. Verify startup type is Automatic.

03 Validate

Run tailscale status and confirm Tailnet connection.

04 Reboot Test

Reboot Windows and verify Tailscale initializes automatically.

05 Escalate If Recurring

If it repeats on every reboot, review Windows Event Logs, check Tailscale version, and service dependencies.

Commands: tailscale status | tailscale up | services.msc